FRAMEWORK

AI Vision Translation Stack for Product Managers

This framework helps AI PMs translate executive AI ambition into shippable product features through four sequential filters.

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AI Vision Translation Stack
for Product Managers

Purpose	Translate executive AI ambition into shippable product features through 4 sequential layers
Flow / Logic	Moves from business metric → user problem → AI necessity check → 90-day scope
Core mechanism	Prevents "pilots that impress execs but never ship" by forcing execution constraint upfront
Risk prevention	Each layer acts as a filter: skip one, you build AI that doesn't move metrics, earn trust, or ship
Time investment	Requires one 90-minute session with exec sponsor, product lead, engineering lead, domain expert
Output	One-page document defining what ships to real users in 90 days with kill switches

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FILTER 1

What the Business Actually Wants

The key question:

"If we build nothing with AI, what business metric suffers in 12 months?"

This layer strips away AI jargon to expose the real business objective. Don't accept "we need AI for documentation" as an answer. Push until you get a number.

The real intention falls into one of five categories: **competitive pressure**, **efficiency mandate**, **revenue growth**, **risk reduction**, or **innovation theater**.

Output:

A one-sentence business objective with a measurable target.

E.g.: *"Reduce physician documentation time by 25% within 12 months," not "leverage AI for clinical workflows."*

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FILTER 2

What User Problem That Solves

The key question:

"What's the user doing today that's painful, slow, or error-prone?"

This layer translates business metrics into user job-to-be-done. Critical constraint: Start with current-state frustration, not future-state possibility.

Executives think in business metrics. Users think in workflow friction. If you can't describe the pain a user feels today without mentioning AI, you're solving the wrong problem.

Output:

A clear before/after statement focused on user experience.

E.g.: *"Physicians spend 4 hours daily on clinical notes"* describes the problem. No mention of LLMs, fine-tuning, or embeddings yet.

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FILTER 3

Where AI Genuinely Helps vs. Where It's Forced

The key question:

"Would this problem still be hard without AI?"

This layer determines whether AI is actually necessary or just fashionable.

AI genuinely helps when: there are too many variables for deterministic rules, the answer depends on context or history, manual work requires expert judgment that's hard to codify, or you need to handle unstructured data at scale.

AI is forced when: a lookup table or filter would work, the problem is actually bad UX design, you're solving for marketing copy rather than user outcomes, or error tolerance is zero.

Output:

A specific AI capability with clear handoff points to non-AI logic.

E.g.: *"Use collaborative filtering for 80% of users, LLM for edge cases where behavior data is sparse," not "AI-powered recommendations."*

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FILTER 4

What Can Ship in 90 Days

The key question:

"What's the smallest version that proves the value and teaches us what we don't know?"

The 90-day constraint is deliberate. If you can't ship something in that timeframe, you're building a pilot, not a product. For AI products, "ship" means validating not just product-market fit but also model performance, data quality, and user trust.

Every 90-day AI shipment requires: one specific use case (not a platform), a human-in-the-loop fallback for errors, observable metrics for both business outcome and model behavior, and a kill switch for when things go wrong.

Output:

This layer converts AI ambition into shippable scope. A specific feature with clear success criteria that ships to real users. Not a prototype. Not a demo. A product.

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